



Dear Rank and Tenure Committee Members,

I am writing in support of Dr. Vladislav Veksler's application for promotion. I first met Vlad when he led my new faculty orientation. For the last several years, he has been one of the first colleagues new faculty meet when they arrive at Caldwell. He is welcoming, easy to approach, and willing to answer questions or help people find the information they need. His role in orientation reflects his ability to connect with people and help them become part of the campus community.

Although I do not teach in Vlad's department, I have seen him interact with his students, especially when computer science students have helped with faculty development events. He has a strong rapport with them, and it is clear they are comfortable working with him. His attendance program for large lecture courses is one example of how he approaches teaching. Students checked in by taking a selfie and identifying where they were sitting. The program made attendance easier, but it also helped Vlad learn students' names and faces. He later shared it with other faculty members who might find it useful.

For the past two years, Vlad and I have served as Co-Directors of the Center for Teaching and Learning and Co-Chairs of the Faculty Development Committee. Vlad approached me about joining him in these roles while I was transitioning from full-time clinical work into a full-time faculty position. Because I teach primarily in an evening graduate program, the role gave me opportunities to work with faculty and staff across the university whom I might not otherwise have met. Vlad helped me enter the role, treated me as an equal partner, and was open to the ideas I brought to our work.

Together, we developed faculty programming in response to changes in higher education, including the growing use of artificial intelligence. Vlad contributed his technical knowledge, but he was also willing to listen, work through questions, and adapt the programming to what faculty needed. This is consistent with what I have seen throughout our work together: he identifies a problem, develops a practical response, and shares what he learns with others.

As Vlad moves into his role as department chair, I expect he will continue to be someone faculty and students rely on. I also know that, although we will no longer formally share these leadership roles, he will remain involved in and supportive of faculty development work.

Vlad is a skilled teacher, supportive colleague, and effective leader. I strongly support his application for promotion.

Sincerely,

Dr. Traci Bitondo